

Impact High · Difficulty Hard · Misuse risk Medium

THE MOVE

Acknowledge their experience -> Make clear you are not agreeing with the claim -> Hold both

START HERE

Say 'I can see why you feel that way' before 'I don't agree with that.' Both sentences. In that order.

SAY THIS

Validation Without Ag... *"I can see why that would feel that way."*

Holding Both *"I can hold both of those at once."*

Close Relationships *"It matters to me that it hurt, even though I would do the same again."*

Workplace Version *"Your reading of the situation is understandable from where you sat. Mine differs, and I want to show you why."*

Holding in the Heat *"I am not going to pretend to agree just to end this — you would see through it anyway."*

AVOID

- When validation is impossible to offer genuinely — offering it dishonestly will be detected.
- When urgency means you need to express your view immediately and pausing to validate would delay a critical decision.
- When the person's position is based on factual errors that your validation might inadvertently reinforce.

REMEMBER

Separate the two sentences and say both.